

makes it easier for governments to survey our data incessantly and impose censorship (such as internet shutdowns discussed in the previous cover story). The risk that's apparent is that if any of these centralised databases shut down, your data is lost. Privacy concerns on the current version of the web are also running rampant since the business models of several companies surround our data and its efficient collection and usage. Why? To target us with specially-curated ads, of course, thereby increasing their sales and revenue.

The DWeb movement expresses interest in reinstating people with the freedom of choice. They get to use the same kind of services but in a decentralised manner. Furthermore, on DWeb, it would be harder for governments to block websites of their choosing, since the information can come from an array of locations.

THE DIFFERENCES

Essentially, the DWeb has two major differences when compared to the world wide web. Firstly, information is gathered and recovered in a different manner. Currently, http and https links are utilised to identify information on the internet. These particular links point to content in a specific location and then our PCs/mobile phones/tablets are tasked with retrieving the information from these locations using the http protocol. DWeb protocols, on the other hand, consist of links which identify and retrieve information based on the content and not where it is stored. Through this content-based approach, information and files can be stored in various locations and can be passed on from one PC to another instead of relying on a central server as

the solitary bearer of said information. Secondly, the DWeb boasts peer-to-peer connectivity, so your computer can not only retrieve information but also provide it.

THE KINKS AND WORKAROUNDS

Nevertheless, the DWeb is not a fool-proof, downside-lacking solution. For instance, online harassment and hate speech can prove to be harder to control since censorship will obviously get harder. Also, if all the data is stored in a decentralised manner, it could become almost impossible to get rid of any of your data entirely. Additionally, while the DWeb will better protect us against cyber criminals, it can also become an almost impenetrable shield for them. As an example, photos of child abuse can be easily stored and shared, and because the data is encrypted, it will become significantly harder to curb such malicious activities.

Nevertheless, once (or if) these kinks are ironed out, DWeb policymakers of the future must focus on the DWeb's advantages, namely the stuff centralised systems cannot do. Some examples include more secure data, privacy, lack of reliance on centralised platforms and even speed. Yes, because of DWeb's structure, it should prove to be significantly faster than conventional internet. We're still a long way away from total adoption since the technology has to be outlined, perfected and adopted. There will be significant pushback from governments, tech giants and even consumers themselves since they will have to revamp their web surfing experience in some ways. Change isn't always welcome, but if this change is welcomed it could change the internet the way we know it today, for good. 

follow the money

Learn how the tech giants, ruling the internet, make their billions

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A popular Silicon Valley proverb goes along the lines of "if you're not paying for it, you're the product". This statement certainly rings true in the light of various privacy concerns and data scandals running rampant as big data becomes more and more prolific. It has revolutionised marketing and advertising, making 'us', the consumers the commodity. Aiding

and abetting this commodification of customers, are the massive tech companies or 'giants', many of who record ads as their biggest area of financial income.

Within the gargantuan technology sector, the ones wielding the maximum power are the Big Five. This is a term used to describe the five most influential and biggest companies or 'giants' in the world of technology including Apple, Amazon, Alphabet, Facebook and Microsoft. These five companies are collectively worth more

than the economies of a few countries such as Saudi Arabia! So, you're bound to be curious about how exactly these tech giants make their billions. Is it through their products? Or, is it through the commodification of their customers/users?

APPLE

Let's start with the big guns, the phenomenon that is Apple. There's no denying that Apple iPhones can single-handedly compete with ALL the